

The formidable gates were locked, but the company managed to slip between the bars and soon found themselves inside a cavernous drinking hall filled with giants enjoying a feast.

Giant King Utgarda-Loki sat at the head of the table, and he laughed when he saw his uninvited guests. “Who are you who’ve crawled under my gate? Mice, are you? Or insects?”

Loki stepped forward before Thor could throw his hammer. “I’m a god,” said Loki, “and I bet I can eat faster than any giant.”

So a trough of roast meat was set down – Loki sat at one end and a giant called Logi sat at the other.



“Eat!” Utgarda-Loki roared, and the feeding-frenzy began. God and giant met in the middle, but where Loki had only eaten the meat, Logi had also stuffed himself with the bones, gristle, and even the trough!

“Giants win!” Utgarda-Loki crowed.

Next, the boy Thjalfi challenged a giant to three running races, but he lost each time.